Problem Chosen	2026 HiMCM/MidMCM Summary Sheet	Team Control Number
B		1111111

Measuring Useful Cooling in Open Systems

Working summary: Requirements 1 and 2

An open freezer case must maintain appropriate product temperatures despite heat exchange with its surroundings. Electricity use alone does not show how well it performs this task.

We distinguish thermal demand, electrical input, and delivered storage service. Infiltration, cabinet heat transfer, internal equipment, restocking, and defrost contribute to demand. Equipment condition modifies performance, while temperature differences across product locations determine whether the intended service is delivered.

We identify four quantities that define cooling service efficiency: energy input, service quantity, local service quality, and service duration. Compliant product mass-hours per kilowatt-hour provide one possible freezer measure. Product-specific temperature requirements remain a separate adequacy check. Comparisons require prescribed loading, matched ambient conditions, and complete operating cycles.

We extend this principle to a regular-size New York City bus shelter, using documented dimensions and a three-zone model. Fan-driven air movement and evaporative temperature/humidity changes feed into a common SET-based hot-discomfort proxy. Signed relief accumulated over passenger-hours is divided by electrical energy, with remaining discomfort reported separately.

Six figures compare local conditions, electricity-normalized relief, humidity, passenger positions, delivery losses, and sensitivity. In the stated illustrative cases, the fan has the highest service efficiency, while the large evaporative cooler leaves the least residual discomfort. A delivery-loss stress test identifies conditions where the smaller evaporative cooler becomes more efficient. These are conditional scenario results, not measured device rankings. The power ratios give transparent break-even requirements: B and C must deliver respectively 4.8 and 10 times A's accumulated relief to exceed its service efficiency.

For a semi-open rail waiting area, a three-zone dynamic model adds air and surface storage, moisture accumulation, passenger loads, and time-dependent outdoor exchange. A matched uncooled trajectory provides the reference, and all deployed units contribute to electricity use. Simulated time histories and exchange sensitivity show how partial enclosure changes delivered service.

Draft status. Requirements 1 and 2 are developed here. Requirements 3–5 and the final whole-paper summary remain to be completed. Numerical results are simulations under explicit assumptions; no field performance measurements are claimed.

Contents

1 Understanding Cooling Efficiency **3**
1.1 Selecting the quantities to evaluate 4
1.2 Factors that explain performance 5
1.3 Implications for the bus-stop model 5

2 Cooling a Bus Stop: From Local Conditions to Passenger Service **6**
2.1 Data, interpretation, and a reproducible scenario 7
2.2 Predicting the local environment 8
2.3 Converting local conditions to a common human response 9
2.4 Measuring service and retaining a quality check 9
2.5 Numerical results: local mechanisms and the efficiency tradeoff 10
2.6 Climate and passenger distribution 12
2.7 When the recommendation changes 13
2.8 Sensitivity, verification, and scope 14

3 Semi-open Rail Waiting Areas: Revising the Bus Model **16**
3.1 Coupled heat, moisture, and surface balances 16
3.2 A matched, reproducible station scenario 17
3.3 Service accounting and numerical findings 18
3.4 What the revision improves, and what remains uncertain 19

References **21**

Report on Use of AI Tools **22**

1 Understanding Cooling Efficiency

An open freezer case succeeds by preserving its products. Low electricity use may reflect a smaller workload, shorter operation, or inadequate temperatures; high heat removal may reflect unwanted environmental heat gains. Cooling efficiency must therefore relate energy input to the storage service actually delivered.

Figure 1 makes the open-front geometry concrete: the front opening permits air exchange, the cabinet surfaces transmit heat, and the shelves separate product locations whose temperatures should be checked. The pictured model is a medium-temperature refrigerated display case [12]; its geometry illustrates these mechanisms, while freezer operating temperatures and product requirements must be specified separately.

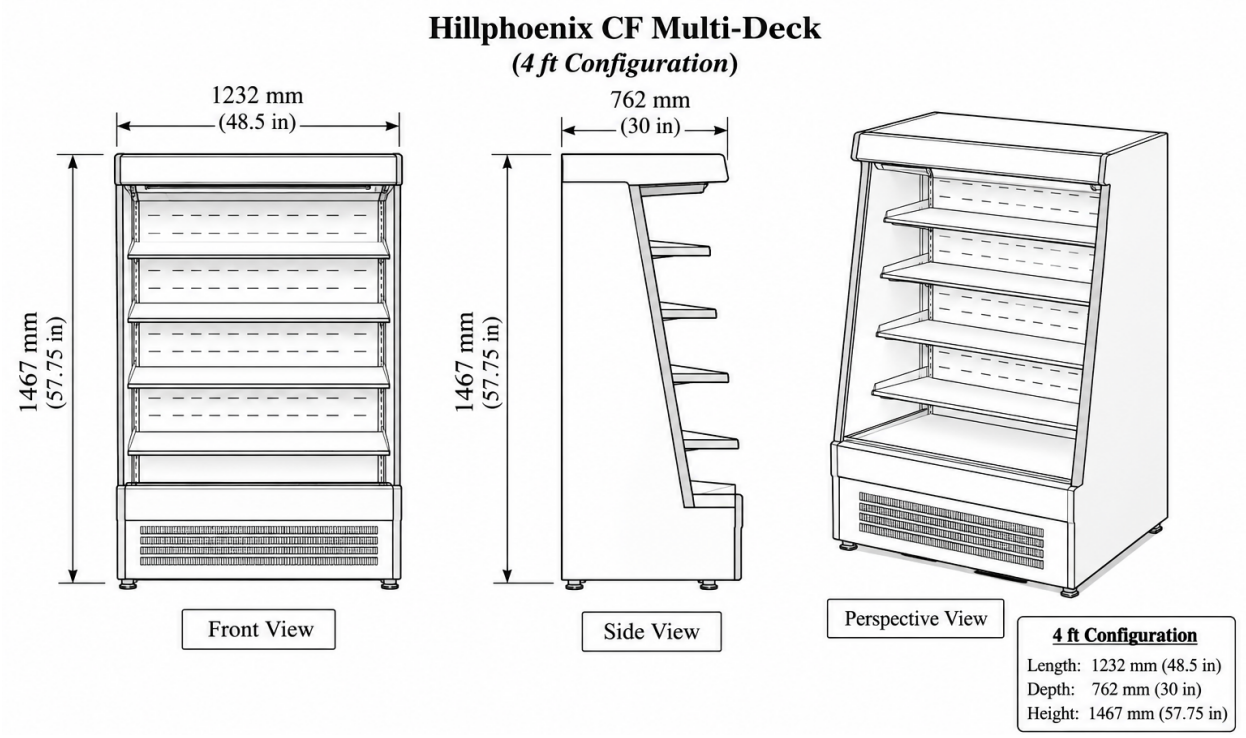


Figure 1: Open-front refrigerated display case: user-supplied schematic with external dimensions matching the Hillphoenix CF-R 4-ft configuration [12]. Millimetre labels are rounded; the internal shelf arrangement is schematic.

1.1 Selecting the quantities to evaluate

Table 1 identifies four quantities that enter the useful-service numerator or energy denominator in both settings.

Table 1: Evaluation quantities and their transfer to a bus stop.

Quantity	Open freezer case	Bus-stop shelter
Energy input	Electricity used by the case and its attributable refrigeration plant (kWh).	Electricity used by fans, pumps, and other cooling equipment (kWh).
Service quantity	Actual mass of products stored under a specified loading protocol (kg).	Number of people present in each occupied zone.
Local service quality	Product temperatures relative to product-specific storage requirements.	Thermal discomfort relative to the same setting without active cooling.
Service duration	Duration of product storage during the evaluation period (h).	Duration of passenger exposure while waiting (h).

Energy input includes auxiliaries and attributable plant electricity without overlapping meter readings. **Service quantity** accounts for workload, subject to prescribed loading limits.

Local service quality requires product temperatures at representative locations, rather than discharge-air temperature alone [1]. Averages can hide a warm shelf, and uniformity does not guarantee acceptable storage; product-temperature requirements remain essential [2].

Service duration distinguishes sustained performance from a favorable snapshot. Include restocking, compressor cycling, and defrost recovery, with comparable initial and final thermal states so that stored cold cannot inflate the result.

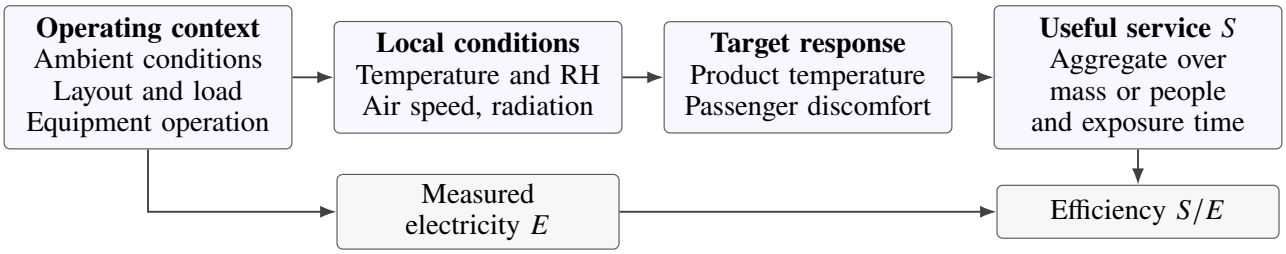


Figure 2: Process linking conditions to service and electricity over the same period ($E > 0$).

1.2 Factors that explain performance

Figure 2 traces how operating conditions become delivered service. The arrows represent physical dependencies and service accounting; feedback and transient responses are handled within the later models. This process-oriented exposition draws on a supplied AI analysis, with the dependencies revised here [15].

From surroundings to local conditions. Infiltration carries sensible heat and moisture through the opening; walls transmit heat, and exposed surfaces exchange radiation. Geometry, insulation, ambient temperature, humidity, and airflow therefore alter the conditions around the products and the refrigeration demand [1].

From operation to local conditions. Lights and fans release heat, warmer incoming stock adds a temporary load, and defrost interrupts normal cooling [1]. Equipment condition changes insulation, airflow, and power demand. These mechanisms affect both local conditions and measured electricity; age itself is not an additional score.

From local conditions to service. Product placement and thermal response determine whether the food remains within its required range. Accumulating compliant product mass over time gives useful storage service. The same sequence applies to passengers, but their response depends on the thermal environment and their exposure, rather than food-temperature limits.

1.3 Implications for the bus-stop model

The preceding analysis motivates a common evaluation principle:

$$\boxed{\text{Cooling efficiency} = \frac{\text{useful service accumulated over objects and time}}{\text{energy input over the same period}}.} \tag{1}$$

The freezer measure can be expressed in compliant kg h per kWh. At a bus stop, useful service accumulates thermal-discomfort reduction over people and waiting time. The next model specifies this response and spatial calculation; the two settings do not have numerically comparable units.

First, **evaluate people directly**. A fan changes local air movement and can improve thermal sensation without lowering air temperature [3]. A direct evaporative cooler changes temperature and humidity [4]. Device-specific mechanisms therefore feed into a common assessment of passenger response.

Second, **weight effects by occupancy**. Geometry and airflow determine which occupied zones benefit; cooling empty space receives no passenger-service credit. Area is not multiplied by total headcount again. Outdoor air exchange may disperse cooled air while changing local air movement, so its effect is assessed through passenger response.

Third, **retain a minimum-service check**. Check individual product-temperature excursions and remaining unacceptable passenger exposure even when aggregate service is high. Partial relief can count as a benefit without establishing adequacy; minimum requirements remain separate from the efficiency score.

Within a venue, compare strategies under matched weather, occupancy, geometry, and evaluation periods. Water use, operating cost, and broader visitor experience enter the later effectiveness model. AI-assisted analysis and drafting are recorded in the appended report [16].

2 Cooling a Bus Stop: From Local Conditions to Passenger Service

We apply the service principle in Section 1 to Requirement 2(a). A device first changes the environment at each passenger's position; those changes alter thermal discomfort; the resulting relief is accumulated over people and time. This separates three questions: how much relief is delivered, where it is delivered, and how much electricity it requires.

We adopt the regular-size New York City shelter in Figure 3 as the common geometry for all three devices. Its documented dimensions provide a reproducible physical scale for the occupied zones.

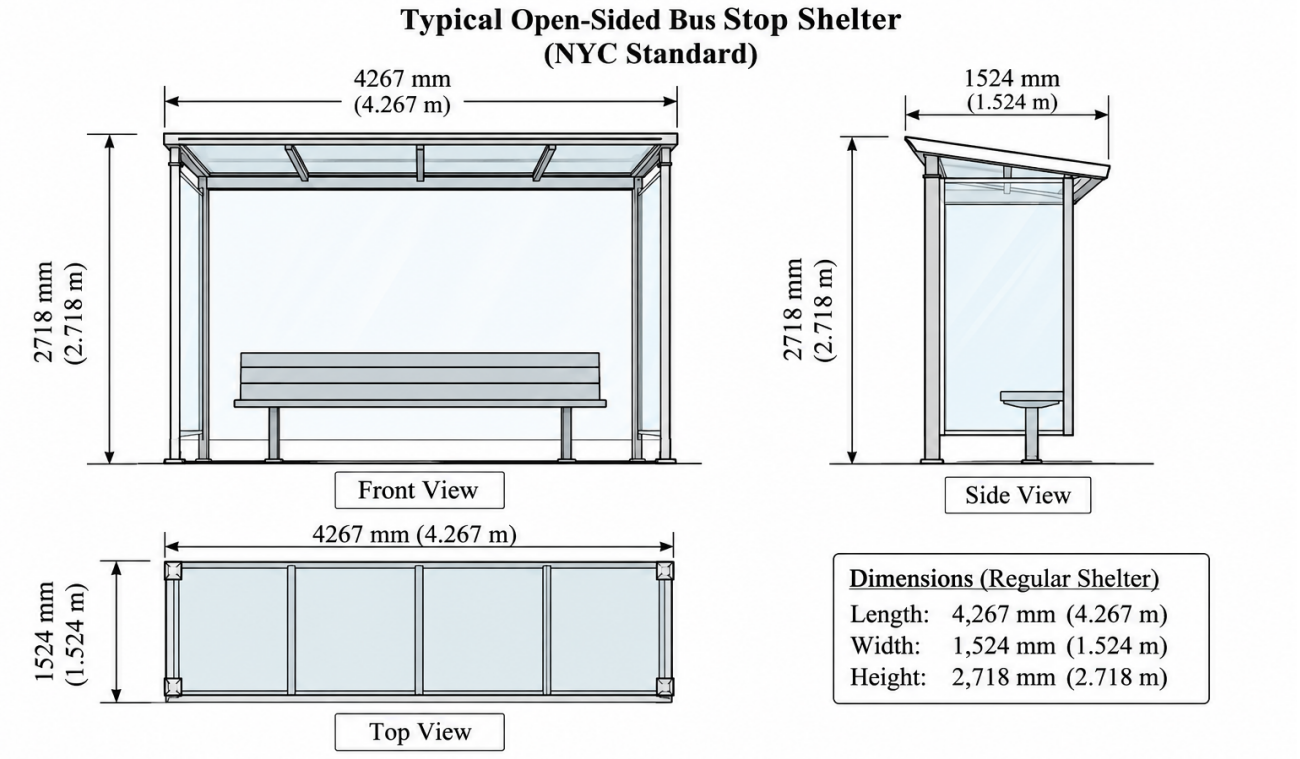


Figure 3: Adopted baseline geometry: regular-size New York City bus shelter. User-supplied schematic; dimensions verified against NYC DOT's *Street Design Manual* [11]. Millimetre labels are rounded.

The official dimensions are 14 ft by 5 ft by 8 ft 11 in [11]. Converting the imperial values before rounding gives $L = 4.2672$, $W = 1.5240$, and $H = 2.7178$ m. We use the gross plan area $A = LW = 6.5032\,\mathrm{m}^2$ and divide the length into three equal strips, each with $A_z = A/3 = 2.1677\,\mathrm{m}^2$. The bench and structure occupy part of this footprint; A is a geometric reference, not a net standing area or a capacity estimate.

Figure 4 fixes the spatial interpretation of near, middle, and edge. Their representative coordinates are $(x_z, W/2)$, with $x_z = (z - \frac{1}{2})L/3$ for $z = 1, 2, 3$. We assume delivery originates at the $x = 0$ end and use the zone-average fields in Table 3. This is a defined layout for comparison; the dimensions alone do not determine air speed or cooling reach.

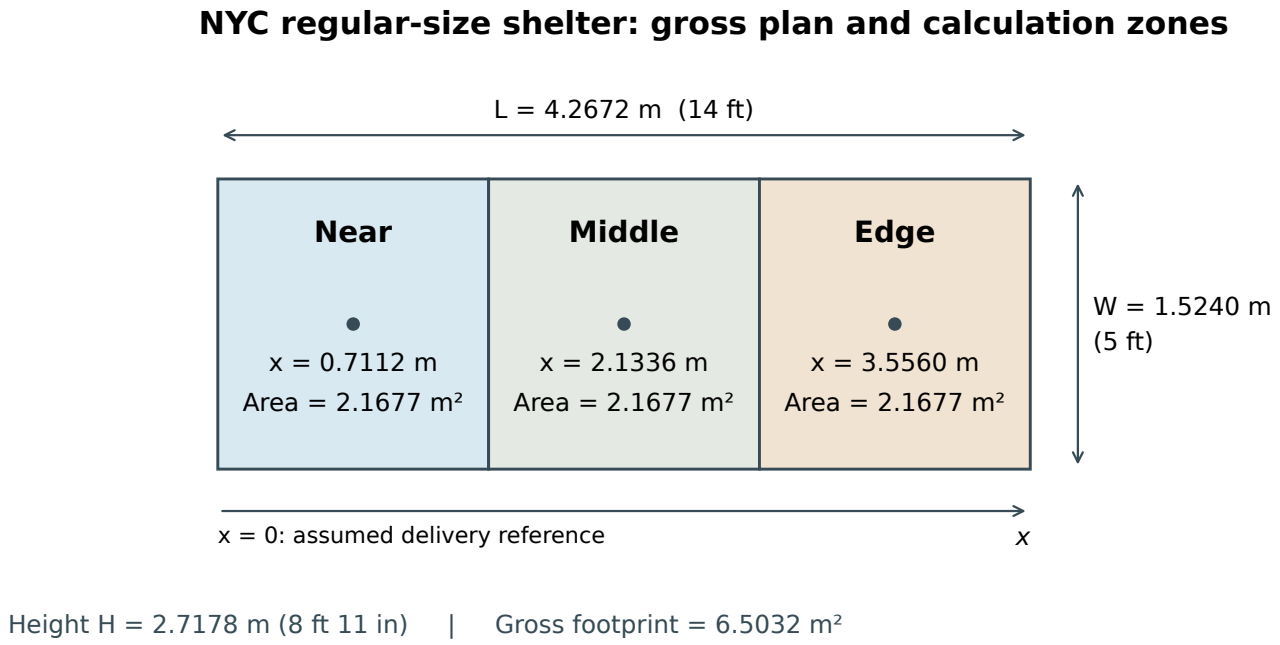


Figure 4: Calculation zones derived from the adopted dimensions. Equal strips and the delivery reference at $x = 0$ are modeling choices; dots mark representative zone coordinates, not passenger locations. No bench or obstruction dimensions are inferred.

2.1 Data, interpretation, and a reproducible scenario

The problem describes A as a fan with an apparent cooling effect of up to 3 °C, and B and C as evaporative coolers with air-temperature reductions of up to 5 and 8 °C [5]. These effects use different temperature concepts. We do not subtract 3 °C from the air temperature for A or treat its unspecified "feels like" index as measured SET.

The table labels energy use in kW/hr. To obtain a dimensionally consistent comparison, **we interpret its numerical entries as mean operating powers** $P_A = 0.25$, $P_B = 1.2$, and $P_C = 2.5$ kW. Thus a one-hour comparison uses 0.25, 1.2, and 2.5 kWh. This is a stated interpretation, not a verified correction to equipment specifications.

The problem supplies no airflow, coverage map, rating weather, or evaporative effectiveness. Therefore, the numerical analysis below is an **illustrative scenario analysis, not an identification of actual device performance**. Table 2 specifies the common environment; Table 3 specifies the uncertain delivered fields before comparing outcomes.

The entries represent zone averages over the strips in Figure 4; they are not measured NYC delivery data. Here $f_{s,z}$ is the local dry-air mass mixing fraction of treated air, not a division of the device's total flow among zones; its three entries need not sum to one. The larger coverage assumed for C is tested, not presented as a fact supplied by the problem.

Table 2: Common inputs: documented geometry and explicit scenario assumptions.

Quantity	Value, basis, and interpretation
Shelter	NYC regular-size geometry: $4.2672 \times 1.5240 \times 2.7178$ m [11]; three equal $2.1677\,\mathrm{m}^2$ gross zones. Full shade is assumed.
Weather	$T_a = 34\,^\circ$C; dry/humid cases RH = 30/70%; sweep 20–80%.
Radiation and background air	Mean radiant temperature $T_r = 36\,^\circ$C; baseline local speed $v_0 = 0.20$ m/s; pressure 101325 Pa.
Reference passenger	Standing, 1.2 met, 0.5 clo; default body area $1.8258\,\mathrm{m}^2$ and zero external work in the SET implementation.
Occupancy and period	Assumed mean simultaneous occupancy $(4, 4, 4)$ over one hour: 12 person-hours; an illustrative load, not a measured count or rated capacity.
Alternative distributions	Concentration stress cases $(8, 3, 1)$ and $(1, 3, 8)$; both retain the same total of 12 people.
Decision threshold	SET threshold $\Theta_c = 26\,^\circ$C, an assumed hot-discomfort reference; tested at 24 and 28 °C.

Table 3: Assumed local delivery profiles. Entries follow near/middle/edge order.

Device	Local air speed (m/s)	Cooled-air mass fraction $f_{s,z}$	ε_s
A	1.00/0.55/0.25	0/0/0	—
B	0.80/0.50/0.30	0.80/0.45/0.10	0.70
C	1.00/0.80/0.50	0.90/0.70/0.40	0.70

2.2 Predicting the local environment

Fan A: air movement. We set $T_{A,z} = T_a$ and retain ambient moisture, while prescribing local speeds from Table 3. The resulting convection and evaporation enter the passenger-response model. This follows the physical distinction between moving air and lowering dry-bulb temperature [7]. We neglect the fan motor's small local heat plume in this open, mixed-air approximation.

B and C: evaporation followed by dilution. Direct evaporation reduces dry-bulb temperature while increasing moisture; the entering wet-bulb temperature T_{wb} limits the achievable depression [6]. We adopt

$$T_{o,s} = T_a - \min\{\Delta T_s^{\max},\ \varepsilon_s(T_a - T_{wb})\}, \qquad s \in \{B, C\}, \tag{2}$$

where $\Delta T_B^{\max} = 5$ and $\Delta T_C^{\max} = 8\,^\circ$C. Applying these advertised shelter-temperature reductions as outlet caps is an explicit modeling convention; the problem does not specify their measurement location. The caps do not imply that either device achieves them under every climate.

Let w denote kg of water vapor per kg of dry air and h the moist-air enthalpy in kJ/kg of dry air. Using standard SI psychrometric relations [10],

$$w = 0.621945\frac{p_v}{p - p_v}, \qquad p_v = \phi p_{sat}(T), \tag{3}$$

$$h(T, w) = 1.006T + w(2501 + 1.86T), \tag{4}$$

where ϕ is RH as a fraction. Approximating evaporation as isenthalpic, $h_{o,s} \simeq h_a$, gives

$$w_{o,s} = \frac{h_a - 1.006T_{o,s}}{2501 + 1.86T_{o,s}}. \tag{5}$$

This neglects fan heat and make-up-water enthalpy; near-constant enthalpy is not an assertion of exact constant wet-bulb temperature [4].

Outdoor dilution is represented by a two-stream balance on dry-air mass:

$$w_{s,z} = (1 - f_{s,z})w_a + f_{s,z}w_{o,s}, \tag{6}$$

$$h_{s,z} = (1 - f_{s,z})h_a + f_{s,z}h_{o,s}, \tag{7}$$

$$T_{s,z} = \frac{h_{s,z} - 2501w_{s,z}}{1.006 + 1.86w_{s,z}}. \tag{8}$$

We recover RH from $T_{s,z}$ and $w_{s,z}$, rather than averaging RH directly. Every calculated state is checked against saturation. This reduced model needs measured local delivery profiles for site-specific predictions; it is not a CFD calculation.

2.3 Converting local conditions to a common human response

We compute standard effective temperature (SET), denoted Θ, from

$$\Theta_{s,z} = F_{\mathrm{SET}}(T_{s,z}, T_{r,z}, v_{s,z}, \phi_{s,z}; \mathrm{met}, \mathrm{clo}). \tag{9}$$

SET compares physiological heat exchange with that in a reference environment, making it more suitable here than air-temperature drop alone [8, 7]. We use the published `pythermalcomfort` implementation with input-domain checks enabled [9]. All scenario inputs remain inside its documented temperature, air-speed, clothing, and activity limits. SET is used as a quasi-steady engineering comparison: its reference conditions originate in typical indoor applications, and it does not model a passenger's prior walking or individual transient response [8].

2.4 Measuring service and retaining a quality check

For the warm-weather scenarios, define the hot-discomfort proxy

$$D(\Theta) = [\Theta - \Theta_c]_+, \qquad [x]_+ = \max(x, 0). \tag{10}$$

The threshold is a decision assumption, not an ASHRAE safety limit. Let 0 denote the same shelter without active cooling, retaining the same shade, weather, radiation, and background air movement. The signed local improvement is

$$b_{s,z,k} = D(\Theta_{0,z,k}) - D(\Theta_{s,z,k}). \tag{11}$$

Negative values are retained: an adverse condition must reduce useful service. Over time steps of Δt_k hours,

$$U_s = \sum_k \sum_z n_{z,k} b_{s,z,k} \Delta t_k, \qquad E_s = \sum_k P_{s,k} \Delta t_k, \tag{12}$$

$$\eta_s = U_s / E_s, \qquad E_s > 0. \tag{13}$$

The unit of η is person·°C·h/kWh, with temperature measured on the SET scale. This is a service-efficiency index, not a thermodynamic percentage or COP. Empty zones earn no credit, although operating electricity is still counted. The zero-energy baseline has no efficiency ratio.

We also report remaining discomfort,

$$R_s = \sum_k \sum_z n_{z,k} D(\Theta_{s,z,k}) \Delta t_k, \qquad \overline{D}_s = \frac{R_s}{\sum_k \sum_z n_{z,k} \Delta t_k}. \tag{14}$$

A high η_s alone does not establish adequate relief. If a decision-maker specifies an acceptable residual or an individual exposure requirement, it should be imposed separately; no universal heat-health threshold is inferred from our SET proxy. When the baseline already meets the chosen hot-discomfort criterion, further cooling earns no benefit, and switching off can be appropriate.

How geometry enters service accounting. The code derives each A_z and its coordinates from L and W. Occupancy may be supplied directly as n_z, as in our comparison, or through a gross-area reference density ρ_z, giving $n_z = \rho_z A_z$. The uniform case corresponds to $12/A = 1.8452$ persons per gross square metre. Concentrating eight people in one strip gives $8/A_z = 3.6905$; this is an abstract crowd-concentration stress case, not a demonstrated feasible standing layout. A deployable layout requires bench and circulation dimensions and revised occupancies.

Area is therefore counted once through population when density is the input. Multiplying U_s by area or total headcount again would double-count service. With headcounts and local fields held fixed, changing geometric dimensions alone leaves U_s unchanged; with gross-area densities and local fields fixed, service scales with area. Both statements are accounting properties, not predictions that airflow is unaffected by shelter size. Increasing every n_z by a common factor cannot change ranking under fixed local conditions.

A ranking result independent of the assumed delivery maps. Under the interpreted constant powers and a common operating period,

$$\begin{aligned} \eta_B > \eta_A &\iff U_B > 4.8 U_A, \\ \eta_C > \eta_A &\iff U_C > 10 U_A, \\ \eta_C > \eta_B &\iff U_C > \frac{25}{12} U_B. \end{aligned} \tag{15}$$

Thus nominal temperature reduction alone cannot justify a larger device. Its accumulated passenger relief must compensate for its larger electricity input. These inequalities follow from the given power ratios; their validity does not depend on the assumed zone profiles.

2.5 Numerical results: local mechanisms and the efficiency tradeoff

Spatial delivery matters even within one small shelter. In the dry case, C gives SET 26.3 °C near the outlet but 29.4 °C at the edge. At RH 70%, these become 33.1 and 35.2 °C. A single mean air-temperature reduction would conceal these differences. A, meanwhile, improves SET without changing the 34 °C dry-bulb temperature.

For uniform occupancy, dry-case efficiencies are 84.6, 24.5, and 21.1 for A, B, and C, respectively. Yet their mean remaining SET excesses are 4.40, 3.72, and 1.76 °C: C delivers more total relief while A

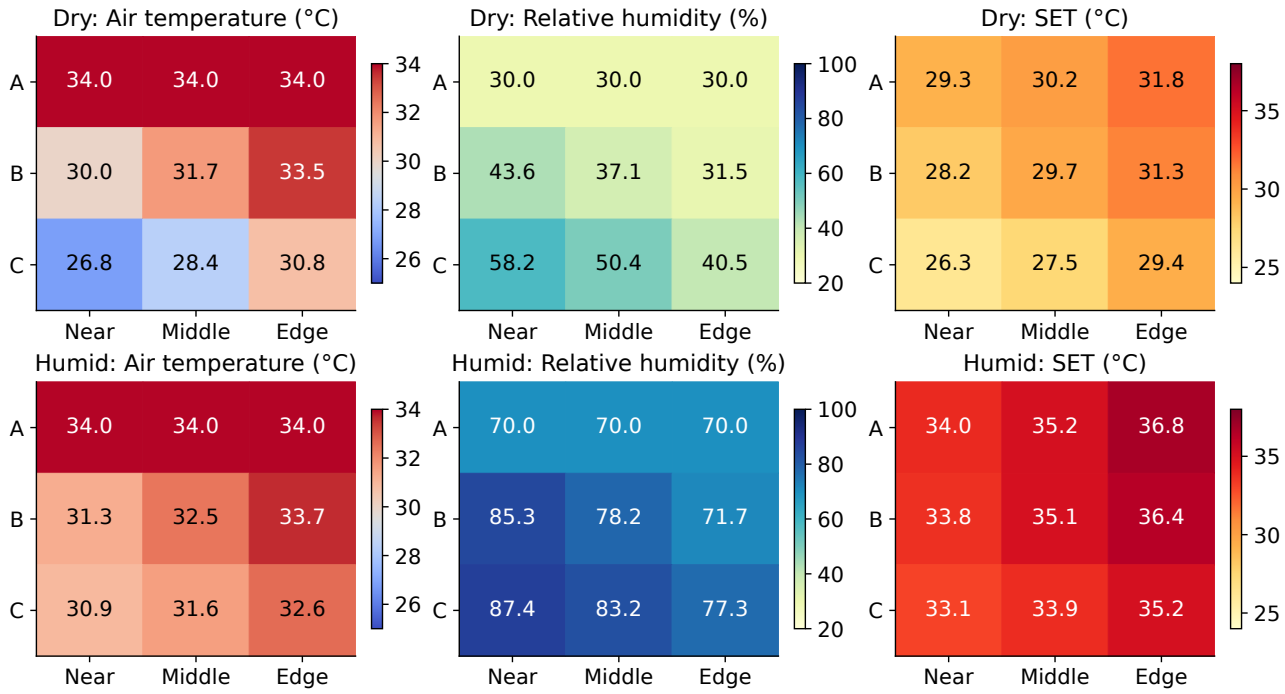


Figure 5: Simulated local air temperature, RH, and SET under the stated assumptions. Fan A leaves air temperature unchanged while changing SET. B and C lower air temperature and increase RH. These are scenario outputs, not field measurements.

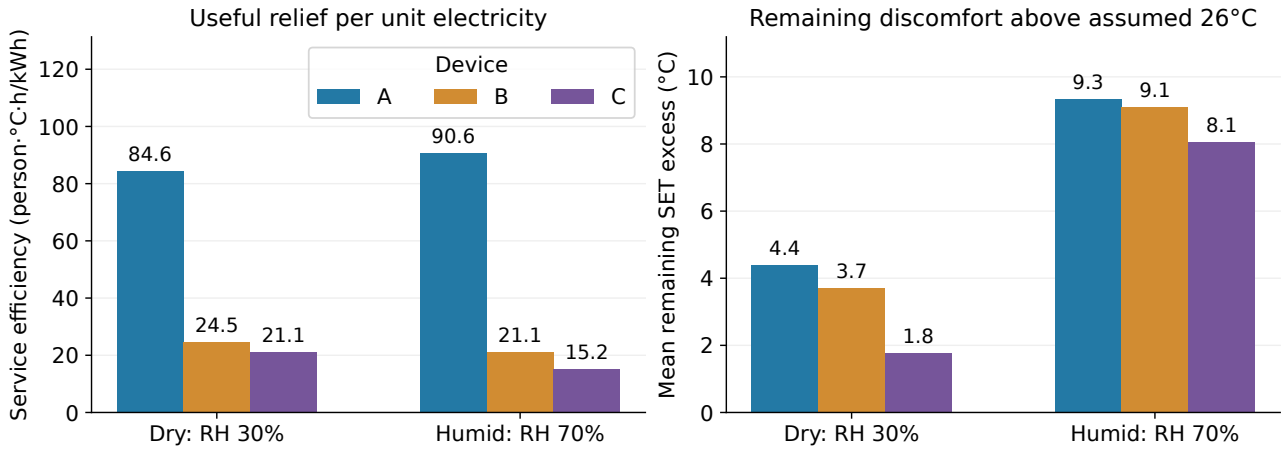


Figure 6: Uniform occupancy: electricity-normalized relief and remaining hot-discomfort proxy. Lower residual is better, whereas higher service efficiency is better. The 26 °C SET reference is assumed.

delivers more per kWh. At RH 70%, efficiencies are 90.6, 21.1, and 15.2; even C retains a mean excess of 8.05 °C. The efficiency winner therefore does not establish that the shelter meets a comfort or safety requirement.

2.6 Climate and passenger distribution

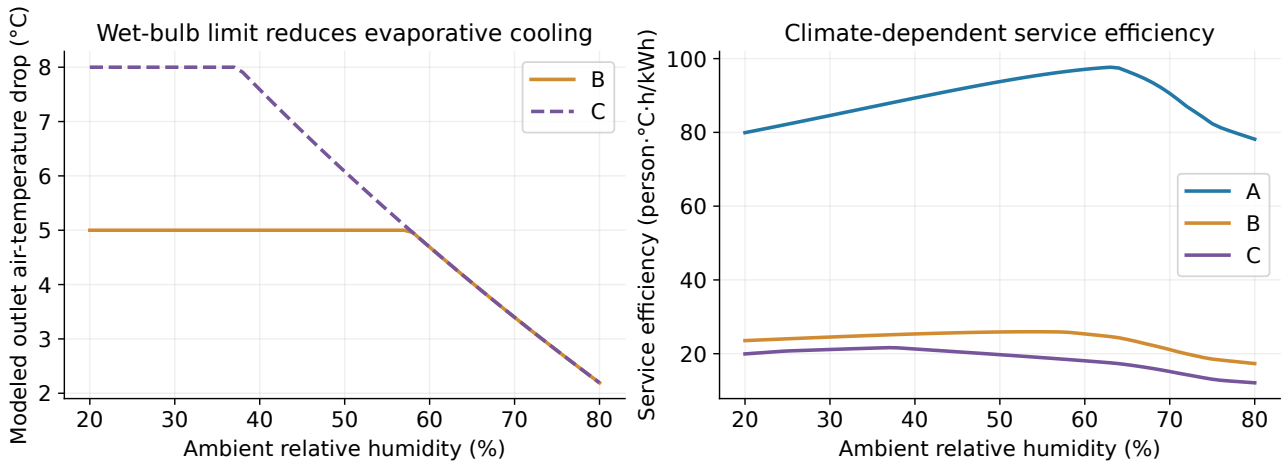


Figure 7: RH sweep with temperature, radiation, occupancy, and delivery profiles fixed. Outlet cooling is bounded by both the specified cap and the wet-bulb depression.

The assumed outlet drops change from 5/8 °C for B/C in the dry case to approximately 3.4/3.4 °C in the humid case. Their common high-humidity outlet temperature follows from the shared assumed $\varepsilon = 0.7$ once neither cap is active; it is not a measured equality between the devices. Remaining performance differences then come from their delivery profiles. Service efficiency need not vary monotonically with RH because SET includes nonlinear human heat exchange and the baseline also changes. Air movement can still provide relief when evaporative temperature reduction weakens.

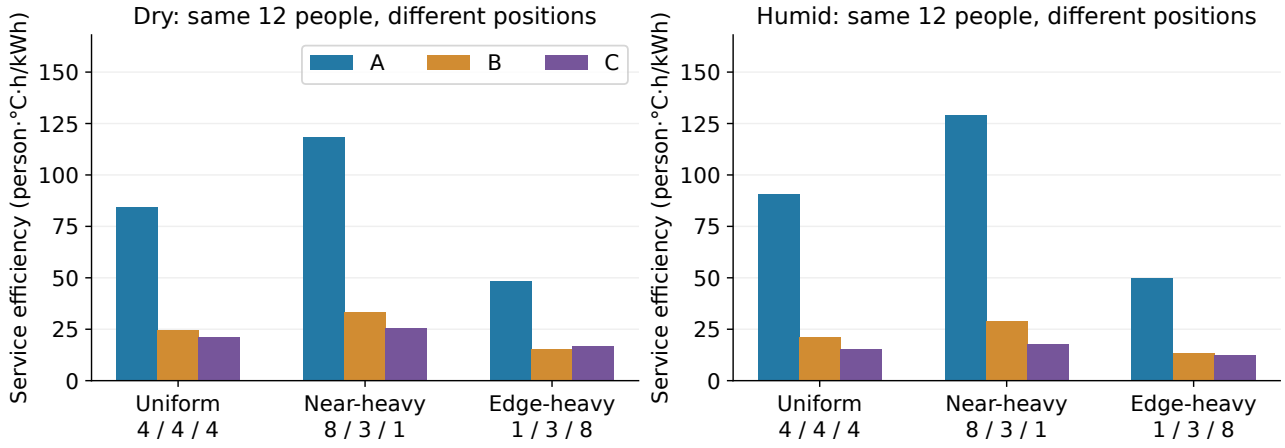


Figure 8: Moving the same 12 mean occupants between near, middle, and edge zones changes delivered service. Labels give the three zone occupancies.

In dry conditions, A's efficiency falls from 118.3 under near-heavy occupancy to 48.3 under edge-heavy occupancy. More importantly, the B/C ordering reverses: under uniform occupancy B exceeds C (24.5 versus 21.1), while at the edge-heavy stop C exceeds B (16.6 versus 15.5). The same total

population is being served; the change comes from where people stand relative to the assumed delivery fields. A remains the most energy-efficient option in all six nominal climate–occupancy cases.

2.7 When the recommendation changes

A poorly aimed or obstructed fan can consume electricity without delivering its nominal air movement to passengers. We test this specific failure mode using

$$v_{A,z}(q) = v_0 + q(v_{A,z}^{\text{nom}} - v_0), \qquad 0 \le q \le 1, \tag{16}$$

while holding $P_A = 0.25$ kW. Here q describes delivery loss at occupied positions, *not* a fan-speed control setting; changing motor speed would require a different power model. The B/C profiles stay fixed in this particular stress test.

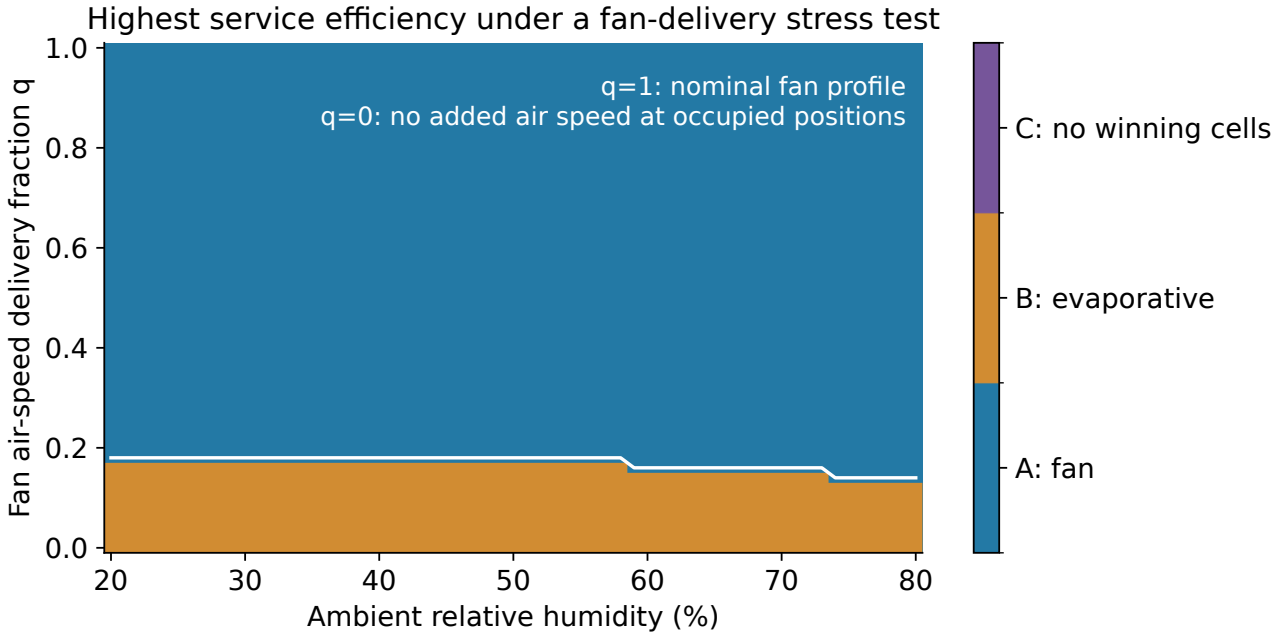


Figure 9: Conditional efficiency winner on the complete RH–fan-delivery grid: RH 20–80% in one-percentage-point steps and q = 0–1 in steps of 0.02. The boundary is grid-resolved. This tests fan delivery loss; it is not a universal climate-selection map.

The first sampled q at which A wins is 0.18 at RH 30% and 0.16 at RH 70%; the corresponding switch lies between that sample and the preceding 0.02 grid step. At lower delivery, B wins. C has no winning cells in this particular grid, although it provides greater absolute relief in the nominal cases. Every humidity column has one contiguous A-winning interval. These boundaries depend on the prescribed B/C fields and are not real-world probabilities or universal fan-performance thresholds.

Operational interpretation. First preserve shade and place people within useful airflow. Compare the measured benefit of improving equipment placement with the benefit of adding cooling capacity. If a larger evaporative system serves substantially more occupied space, use Eq. (15) with its measured

service to decide whether that expansion compensates for electricity use. In humid conditions, an assumed larger nominal temperature drop cannot override the wet-bulb constraint.

A field calibration would measure (T, RH, v, T_r) at occupied positions within the documented strips, electricity over the same period, and occupancy by zone. Net usable area and actual device placement would also be recorded. Repeated matched weather and occupancy conditions would allow the assumed profiles in Table 3 to be replaced and the ranking checked. The quoted $3/5/8\,^{\circ}\mathrm{C}$ effects alone cannot supply this calibration.

2.8 Sensitivity, verification, and scope

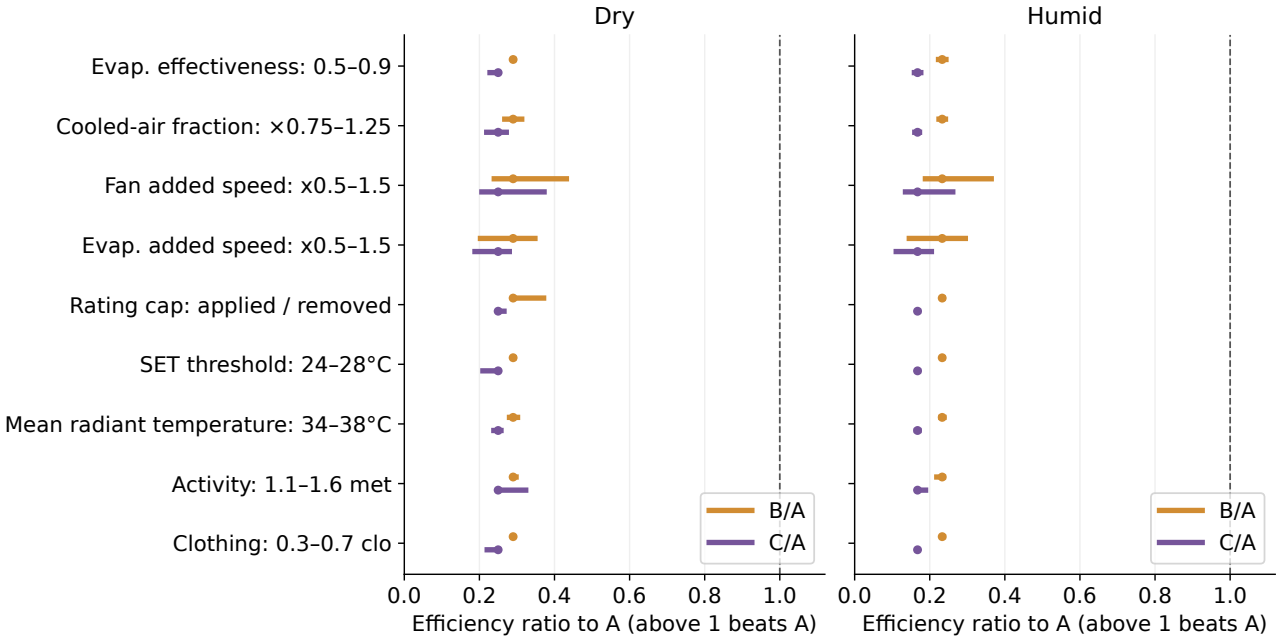


Figure 10: One-factor-at-a-time sensitivity at the two endpoint settings listed on each row; dots mark nominal ratios. An interval above one would favor the evaporative device over A. These are assumed parameter ranges, not statistical confidence intervals. Joint uncertainty can produce changes beyond these endpoint tests.

Across the tested individual endpoint changes, the largest B/A and C/A efficiency ratios are 0.432 and 0.372; no endpoint reverses the nominal advantage of A. This does not prove robustness over every intermediate value or joint parameter combination. Added-speed factors scale $v - v_0$, and cooled-air fractions are capped at one. The rating-interpretation test removes the $5/8\,^{\circ}\mathrm{C}$ outlet caps while retaining the wet-bulb constraint; it addresses uncertainty in where the quoted temperature effects were measured. The delivery-loss test in Figure 9 already demonstrates that stronger departures can change the winner.

Verification. The implementation checks psychrometric round trips, dry-air moisture/enthalpy mixing balances, wet-bulb bounds, and saturation. Service-accounting checks verify $U_s + R_s = R_0$, zero benefit at zero occupancy, zero benefit when all delivered effects vanish, and unchanged rankings when every zone's population doubles. A signed-adverse-effect check confirms that worsening discomfort is not

clipped away. No credit is given for additional cooling of an already comfortable baseline. Geometry checks verify unit conversion and area conservation, equivalence of count and density inputs, fixed-count invariance, and fixed-density scaling under unchanged local fields.

Limitations and transfer. Local profiles and representative passengers remain assumptions; the numerical ranking is conditional on them. Airflow and dilution are prescribed rather than solved from fan curves, mass flow, crosswind, and shelter geometry. Radiation is fixed for a shaded shelter, so direct sun and changing shadow patterns need additional modeling. Short waiting times and varied physiological histories are not resolved by quasi-steady SET. Without measured flow, water consumption cannot be calculated reliably from the moisture increase alone; water and operating cost belong in the later effectiveness analysis. Section 3 retains this service accounting and adds surface heat storage and dynamic air/moisture exchange for a semi-open station.

Reproducibility. Calculations use `pythermalcomfort` 4.8.1 and PsychroLib 2.5.0. The accompanying `model` folder contains the sourced geometry, scenario assumptions, psychrometric/SET backend, executable simulation, CSV outputs, and source audit. A geometry audit records zone coordinates, areas, and implied occupancies; six numerical figures and the zoning diagram have reproducible source code. Each figure is loaded from a separate PDF in the `figures` folder, allowing independent replacement. Software versions and checks are saved with the results. Simulations quantify the stated assumptions; they do not constitute experimental validation.

3 Semi-open Rail Waiting Areas: Revising the Bus Model

Requirement 2(b) retains the service objective, but changes how local conditions are obtained. A roof and partial walls permit air and surface temperatures to retain a history of earlier loads. Evaporative devices can humidify recirculated air, while passengers and outdoor exchange vary over a train cycle. We therefore replace prescribed temperature/humidity fields with a three-zone dynamic control-volume model. The zones represent the entrance, waiting core, and platform edge; they need not share the same conditions.

Table 4: Revisions to the bus model and their purpose.

Revision	Why it is needed	Added capability
Air and surface storage	Partial enclosure allows thermal memory.	Predict warm-up, lag and residual heat.
Dynamic moisture and zone exchange	Recirculation changes inlet humidity; openings connect different regions.	Calculate evaporative feedback and dilution.
Time-dependent passengers	Arrivals and boarding change both loads and service demand.	Count time-resolved person-hours and crowd heat/moisture.
All devices and their heat	Several units consume power and release heat within the station.	Use total electricity and include local dissipation.

3.1 Coupled heat, moisture, and surface balances

Following the control-volume structure of building heat and moisture balances [13], let each zone store moist-air enthalpy h_z (J/kg dry air), humidity ratio w_z (kg/kg dry air), and an effective roof/wall inner-surface temperature $T_{m,z}$. The air is well mixed within each zone. Its dry-air mass is approximated as constant, $M_z = \rho_{da,o} V_z$, with outdoor reference density. This is a reduced model, not an EnergyPlus or CFD simulation.

Define the exchange operator, for either $x = h$ or w, as

$$\mathcal{L}_z(x) = \dot{m}_{0z}(x_o - x_z) + \sum_{j \neq z} \dot{m}_{zj}(x_j - x_z), \qquad \dot{m}_{0z} = M_z \lambda_z / 3600. \tag{17}$$

Here λ_z is the assumed outdoor air-change rate in h^{-1}. Each exchange represents equal entering and leaving dry-air flow; adjacent-zone rates satisfy $\dot{m}_{zj} = \dot{m}_{jz}$. Wind, buoyancy and opening geometry can affect outdoor exchange [14]; a prescribed train-cycle pulse tests that uncertainty without claiming a station-specific piston-flow law.

With time in seconds, our balances are

$$M_z \dot{h}_z = \mathcal{L}_z(h) + H_{ma,z}(T_{m,z} - T_z) + n_z q_c + n_z g h_v(T_z) + P_z + \dot{m}_{e,z}(h_{e,z} - h_z), \tag{18}$$

$$M_z \dot{w}_z = \mathcal{L}_z(w) + n_z g + \dot{m}_{e,z}(w_{e,z} - w_z), \tag{19}$$

$$C_{m,z} \dot{T}_{m,z} = H_{mo,z}(T_o - T_{m,z}) + Q_{\mathrm{sol},z} + n_z q_r - H_{ma,z}(T_{m,z} - T_z). \tag{20}$$

The per-person inputs are convective heat q_c, radiative heat q_r, and water-vapor generation g. Vapor enters with $h_v(T) = 2501000 + 1860T$ J/kg; no additional latent-heat term is added. All device power

P_z is assumed to dissipate locally as sensible heat. Pump power is already included in the device total. Conductances H have units W/K, surface capacity C_m has units J/K, and Q_{sol} is an effective absorbed envelope load. The opposite signs of the air–surface term conserve internal energy.

Air temperature is recovered from $T_z = (h_z - 2501000w_z)/(1006 + 1860w_z)$. A shaded longwave approximation for the surface contribution to comfort [8] gives

$$T_{r,z} = \left[F_z(T_{m,z} + 273.15)^4 + (1 - F_z)(T_{r,o} + 273.15)^4\right]^{1/4} - 273.15. \tag{21}$$

F_z is an assumed effective view fraction; the example sets external radiant temperature $T_{r,o} = T_o$, while keeping it a separate input. Direct sun on passengers and detailed radiative asymmetry are excluded.

Device mechanisms. A adds air movement and electrical heat, with $\dot{m}_e = 0$. B/C recirculate local air: at every step Eq. (2) is evaluated using the *current zone inlet*, rather than fixed outdoor conditions. Their approximate outlet enthalpy remains $h_{e,z} = h_z$, while $w_{e,z} > w_z$ when evaporation occurs. Thus evaporation can lower dry-bulb temperature without removing moist-air enthalpy. Rising local moisture reduces subsequent wet-bulb depression. The earlier fixed mixing fractions are replaced by these explicit flow balances. Local passenger air speeds remain stated assumptions, rather than solutions of a momentum model.

3.2 A matched, reproducible station scenario

We use an illustrative $24 \times 10 \times 4$ m waiting area, divided along its length into three $80\,\mathrm{m}^2$ zones of $320\,\mathrm{m}^3$ each. These are scenario dimensions, not measurements of a named station. Outdoor temperature is 33 °C, with RH 30% and 70%. SET retains the bus model's 1.2 met, 0.5 clo, and common 26 °C reference.

Table 5: Explicit rail-scenario assumptions; zone vectors follow entrance/core/platform order.

Input	Assumed value
Train cycle and passengers	Every 15 min, n_z rises linearly from $(6, 10, 4)$ toward $(20, 45, 15)$, then resets after boarding.
Outdoor and zone exchange	Base $\lambda = (8, 4, 10)$ h^{-1}; add $(8, 4, 12)$ h^{-1} in the final 2 min of each cycle. Adjacent zones exchange 0.20 kg dry air/s.
Surface response, each zone	$C_m = 4.0$ MJ/K, $H_{ma} = 200$ W/K, $H_{mo} = 400$ W/K, $Q_{\mathrm{sol}} = 800$ W; $F = (0.55, 0.85, 0.55)$.
Per-person sources	$q_c = 45$ W, $q_r = 30$ W, $g = 45/(2.45 \times 10^6)$ kg/s. Fixed representative loads, not measured passenger emissions.
Equipment count and power	One unit per zone: total 0.75/3.60/7.50 kW for A/B/C. All three units run throughout the two-hour assessment.
Evaporative recirculation	B/C: 0.60/1.20 kg dry air/s per zone; $\varepsilon = 0.70$; outlet caps 5/8 °C.
Passenger air speeds	Baseline 0.20 m/s; A $(0.60, 1.00, 0.50)$, B $(0.50, 0.80, 0.45)$, C $(0.75, 1.00, 0.60)$ m/s.

The three sources of information remain separate: powers and nominal effect descriptions come from the problem, balance mechanisms come from the cited literature, and the station geometry, flows, loads and schedules are assumptions. We do not fit them to obtain a preferred device ranking.

Each climate–exchange case first receives a prescribed two-hour uncooled warm-up from outdoor air and surface conditions. All strategies then start from that *same* warm-up state and are assessed for two hours. The independent no-device trajectory uses identical passengers, weather and exchange. This specifies a common prior history; it is not a claim that a periodic steady state has been reached. It prevents stored cooling from being supplied free at the initial time. Later benefits beyond the assessment horizon are not credited.

3.3 Service accounting and numerical findings

For each strategy, compute $\Theta_{s,z}(t)$ from the evolving $(T_z, T_{r,z}, v_{s,z}, \mathrm{RH}_z)$, and retain the original signed accounting:

$$\eta_s = \frac{\int_0^{2\mathrm{h}} \sum_z n_z(t)\{D[\Theta_{0,z}(t)] - D[\Theta_{s,z}(t)]\}\,dt}{\int_0^{2\mathrm{h}} \sum_z P_{s,z}(t)\,dt}. \tag{22}$$

Time in this integral is measured in hours and power in kW. The two-hour electricity totals are 1.5, 7.2, and 15.0 kWh. Average remaining discomfort is reported alongside efficiency, so high passenger throughput cannot substitute for adequate local relief. The baseline ratio is undefined because its active-cooling energy is zero.

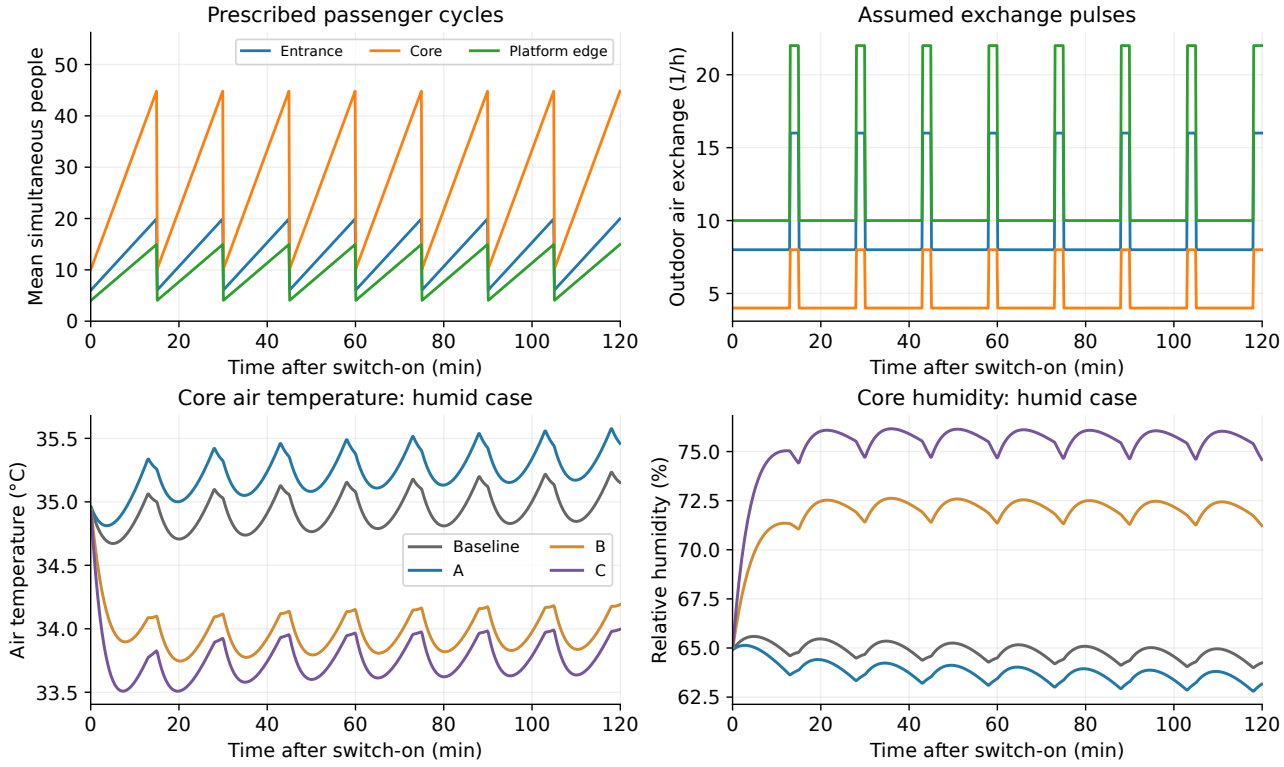


Figure 11: Assumed passenger/air-exchange cycles and simulated waiting-core temperature and RH in the humid rail scenario. The device cases and uncooled baseline start from the same state.

The evaluation contains 100 person-hours. In the dry case, A/B/C provide efficiencies of 145.9/35.6/26.1 person·°C·h/kWh and mean remaining SET excesses of 3.62/3.24/1.90 °C. A uses

electricity most efficiently, while C delivers the greatest average relief. In the humid case, efficiencies are 168.7/29.4/15.3, and remaining excesses are 8.04/8.45/8.27 °C. Under these particular flows and loads, A also gives the lowest remaining discomfort. No case establishes adequate thermal protection merely by winning this comparison.

In the humid core, B and C reach RH peaks of 72.6% and 76.2%, compared with 65.1% for A. Figure 11 exposes the evolving inlet conditions that a fixed outdoor-state calculation would miss. These rail results use different geometry, loads and delivery assumptions from the bus example; their differing rankings alone do not measure a gain in predictive accuracy.

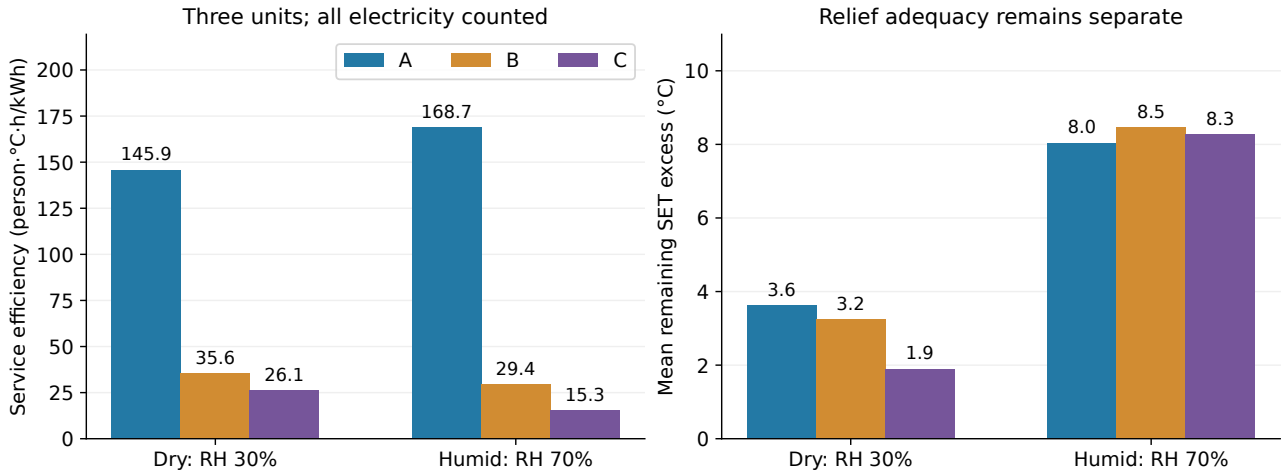


Figure 12: Rail-scenario service efficiency and mean remaining SET excess, with all three units' electricity included. Results are conditional simulations, not station measurements.

The exchange sweep shows competing effects. For dry-case C, efficiency at multipliers 0.5, 1, and 3 is 24.5, 26.1, and 23.5: more exchange removes retained moisture and heat but also dilutes cooling. The best of these sampled settings is not a universally optimal ventilation rate. For humid-case C, the same settings give 10.1, 15.3, and 19.6, while mean remaining excess falls from 9.48 to 8.27 to 7.22 °C. Thus treating all outdoor exchange as waste would conceal a useful heat/moisture removal mechanism. Local air speeds remain fixed in this diagnostic sweep.

3.4 What the revision improves, and what remains uncertain

The revised model can evaluate when moisture accumulates, how the core differs from an exposed edge, and how a train-cycle crowd changes both thermal demand and useful service. It also makes finite air residence and surface thermal memory explicit. The bus model's fixed profiles could not resolve those histories. Consequently, the revision improves the *questions the model can answer*; an improvement in field prediction accuracy still requires measured temperatures, RH, air speeds, surface temperatures, occupancy and electricity.

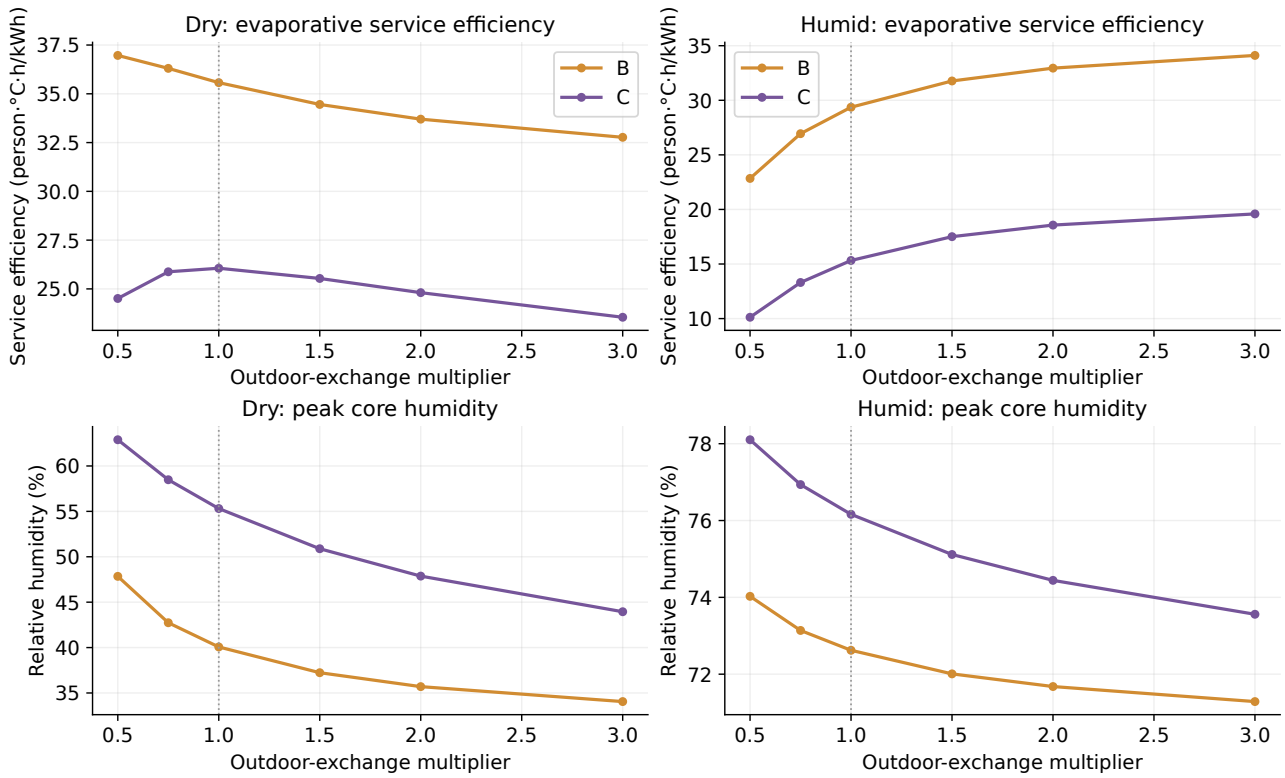


Figure 13: Outdoor-exchange sensitivity with equipment, local passenger air speeds and other inputs fixed. Each case uses its own matched uncooled baseline. The sweep isolates heat/moisture exchange; it does not predict a complete opening redesign.

Verification. The solver uses RK4 with a 10 s step and midpoint schedule values; steps align with every pulse and boarding boundary. Halving the step changes efficiency by less than 0.001% and mean remaining discomfort by less than 10^{-5} °C in all nominal cases. Checks close total air-plus-surface energy and water-vapor budgets, verify internal exchange cancellation, reproduce an unloaded equilibrium, and retain zero service at zero occupancy despite positive device electricity. The service identity $U_s + R_s = R_0$ also holds. These checks establish numerical consistency, not field accuracy.

The accompanying `station_model` folder contains the scenario, solver, CSV trajectories, initial states, sensitivity results and verification records. SET remains a quasi-steady human-response calculation even though the environment is dynamic. The model neglects surface moisture sorption, condensation, detailed stratification and direct solar exposure. It stops on invalid humidity or SET inputs instead of hiding them. Outdoor exchange and local air speeds need field calibration before operational recommendations; the exchange sweep is a thermal comparison, not a ventilation or safety compliance assessment.

References

[1] ASHRAE. *2026 ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*, Chapter 15, *Retail Food Store Refrigeration and Equipment*. Product Temperatures and Display Refrigerator Cooling Load sections. https://handbook.ashrae.org/Handbooks/R26/IP/r26_ch15/r26_ch15_ip.aspx. Accessed November 7, 2026.

[2] UK Department for Energy Security and Net Zero. *Energy Technology List: Retrofit Measures for Open Fronted Refrigerated Display Cabinets*. Definitions and product-temperature performance requirements. https://etl.energysecurity.gov.uk/products/refrigeration-equipment/retrofit-measures-open-fronted-refrigerated-display-cabinets. Accessed November 7, 2026.

[3] ENERGY STAR. *Ceiling Fan Installation and Usage Tips*. https://www.energystar.gov/products/ceiling_fans/installation-and-usage-tips. Accessed November 7, 2026.

[4] ASHRAE. *2023 ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*, Chapter 53, *Evaporative Cooling*. https://handbook.ashrae.org/Handbooks/A23/SI/A23_Ch53/a23_ch53_si.aspx. Accessed November 7, 2026.

[5] COMAP. *2026 HiMCM Problem B: Air Conditioning the Environment: Modeling Energy Waste in Public Cooling*. User-supplied problem statement, Requirement 2(a), p. 2.

[6] ASHRAE. *2020 ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Systems and Equipment*, Chapter 41, *Evaporative Air-Cooling Equipment*, Section 1. https://handbook.ashrae.org/handbooks/S20/SI/s20_ch41/s20_ch41_si.aspx. Accessed November 7, 2026.

[7] Center for the Built Environment, University of California, Berkeley. *Fans for Cooling People Guidebook: Elevated Air Speed and Thermal Comfort*. https://cbe-berkeley.gitbook.io/fans-guidebook/full-guidebook/elevated-air-speed-and-thermal-comfort. Accessed November 7, 2026.

[8] ASHRAE. *2017 ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, Chapter 9, *Thermal Comfort*, Section 10, Environmental Indices. https://handbook.ashrae.org/Handbooks/f17/IP/f17_ch09/f17_ch09_ip.aspx. Accessed November 7, 2026.

[9] Tartarini, F., and Schiavon, S. (2020). pythermalcomfort: A Python package for thermal comfort research. *SoftwareX*, 12, 100578. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.softx.2020.100578. SET API and applicability limits: https://pythermalcomfort.readthedocs.io/en/stable/documentation/models.html. Accessed November 7, 2026.

[10] Meyer, D., and Thevenard, D. (2019). PsychroLib: a library of psychrometric functions to calculate thermodynamic properties of air. *Journal of Open Source Software*, 4(33), 1137. https://doi.org/10.21105/joss.01137. SI psychrometric API: https://psychrometrics.github.io/psychrolib/api_docs.html. Accessed November 7, 2026.

[11] New York City Department of Transportation. *Street Design Manual: Bus Stop Shelter*, Description (regular-size shelter). https://www.nycstreetdesign.info/furniture/bus-stop-shelter. Accessed November 7, 2026.

[12] Hillphoenix. *CF-R/CF-FS-R/CF-S-R Multi-Deck Merchandiser: Installation & Operations Manual*, April 2021, Technical Reference, printed p. 4 (PDF p. 8). https://www.hillphoenix.com/wp-content/uploads/2021/06/CF-S-R-display-case-manual.pdf. Product classification: https://www.hillphoenix.com/products/cf. Accessed November 7, 2026.

[13] EnergyPlus Development Team. *Engineering Reference*, "Basis for the Zone and Air System Integration" and "Moisture Predictor-Corrector." https://energyplus.readthedocs.io/en/latest/guides/engineering-reference/2.1-basis-for-the-zone-and-air-system-integration.html; https://energyplus.readthedocs.io/en/latest/guides/engineering-reference/2.4-moisture-predictor-corrector.html. Accessed November 7, 2026.

[14] ASHRAE. *2025 ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, Chapter 16, *Ventilation and Infiltration*, Section 10, Natural Ventilation. https://handbook.ashrae.org/Handbooks/F25/SI/F25_Ch16/F25_Ch16_si.aspx. Accessed November 7, 2026.

[15] Google Gemini. *AI-generated analysis of the 2026 HiMCM Problem B*, user-supplied PDF conversation excerpt, November 2026. Consulted for process-oriented exposition; the proposed efficiency formula was reviewed but not adopted. Exact model identifier was not available in the supplied excerpt.

[16] OpenAI. *Codex*, AI-assisted formulation, reference checking, English drafting, and LaTeX preparation, November 2026. Exact deployed model identifier to be recorded from the session interface. See the preliminary AI-use record following this draft.

[17] COMAP. *Use of AI Tools in COMAP Contests*, v102025. https://www.contest.comap.com/undergraduate/contests/mcm/flyer/Contest_AI_Policy.pdf. Accessed November 7, 2026.

Report on Use of AI Tools

Preliminary record for this partial draft.

OpenAI Codex assisted with translation, modeling, coding and drafting Requirements 1 and 2 in November 2026. Record the exact deployed model identifier from the session interface.

The user requested an English section in the supplied template covering infiltration, cabinet heat transfer, internal equipment, restocking, defrost and operating cycles, equipment age, and spatial temperatures. This is a summary of the request, not a verbatim transcript.

Codex simplified the evaluation framework, checked sources, drafted the text, and prepared the LaTeX. AI review checked technical consistency. At the user's request, the 2025 Problem B solutions of Teams 16442, 16738, and 16739 were reviewed as structural references. Their numerical estimates, weighting procedures, and wording were not used in the present model. No field measurements or empirical performance results were produced.

A user-supplied Google Gemini conversation excerpt was subsequently reviewed. Its process-oriented explanation informed the organization of the new diagram; Codex redrew and revised the dependencies and service definitions. The Gemini model identifier and complete conversation were not available in that excerpt. The relevant Gemini prompts and outputs must also be included in the final record.

For Requirement 2(a), the user authorized development of the bus-stop extension, requested explicit citations, and asked for multiple charts. Codex formulated the three-zone scenario, wrote Python code, used PsychroLib and pythermalcomfort for psychrometric and SET calculations, generated six figures and CSV results, and drafted the accompanying interpretation. AI review passes checked the physical assumptions, source support, and correspondence between equations and code. The numerical checks establish internal consistency; no field validation is claimed. Unmeasured delivery profiles are explicitly labeled assumptions. Software versions are recorded with the results. This paragraph summarizes contributions; preserve the full prompts, outputs and code-generation record.

A user-supplied bus-shelter schematic was later incorporated as an external PDF. Codex checked its dimension labels against the official NYC Street Design Manual, added attribution, and adopted its dimensions for the scenario. Codex derived equal zones, updated occupancy accounting, added geometry checks and a PDF zoning diagram, and rechecked results. The original image was preserved; its page viewport was adjusted to place numbering and attribution in the caption.

A second user-supplied schematic of an open refrigerated display case was incorporated into Requirement 1 as a separate PDF. Codex checked the model classification and dimensions against the manufacturer's material, added source attribution and a structural explanation, and preserved the original image. The figure illustrates geometry; no freezer performance data were inferred.

For Requirement 2(b), Codex developed coupled zone enthalpy, moisture and surface-energy balances, implemented a dynamic station scenario, and generated three separate PDF figures. AI review checked conservation, vapor-source accounting, source support, and numerical consistency. Geometry, equipment flows and train/passenger schedules remain explicit scenario assumptions. The work did not include field measurements or empirical model validation.

Before submission, add exact relevant prompts and complete outputs for all retained contributions and AI tools, following the contest guidance [17]. Retain this source and chat as records. Independent student verification has not been asserted in this preliminary record.